

at noon and reposeful green idle days. There is an ennui of afternoons and summers in the emotional climate of *Retreat*, a beachscape with lolling figures realized pictorially through simplified means. *Woodstockia* isolates a girl locked in a daydream and drenched in comfort and in innocent escape from it. The aloof and contained *Nantucket Landscape* stands darkly alone among these glowing compositions.

G. S.

NEW YORK HERALD TRIBUNE
SATURDAY, MARCH 23, 1957

Art Exhibition Notes

Sievan at Passedoit

The sultry mood that overlays the work of Maurice Sievan, giving it a brooding tone is a marked characteristic of this artist's exhibition at the Passedoit Gallery. His interest as an artist is clearly in the outdoor world, as in "Suburbia" and "Harbor," both combining good vision and spirited brushwork. But also shown is work with human figures and landscape, somewhat different from the usual—more spacious, mysterious and indicative of a new imaginative development of his art.

C. B.

THE NEW YORKER APRIL 6, 1957

MAURICE SIEVAN—Dreamily misty, predominantly wistful landscapes, occasionally with figures; through Saturday, April 6. (Passedoit, 121 E. 57th St.)

Maurice Sievan, PROVINCETOWN HARBOR; at Passedoit.

PAINTINGS by Maurice Sievan at the Passedoit Gallery include both early and recent canvases. All of his work is marked by delicate adjustments of tones, richness of textures and an ability to subordinate detail to breadth of statement. Out of such unpromising material as a suburban street he has often created a persuasive vision through the skillful breaking up of light planes and the harmonizing of linear pattern with the plastic design. He has never been guilty of sentimentalizing such subjects, but through sensitive perception of the relations of shapes and forms and the variation of textural surfaces has found an appealing pictorial idea. In his more recent canvases his handling is freer, forms are less explicit, subjects more broadly developed with what may appear to be casualness but which is in reality a knowing subtlety. A single color key is usually sustained throughout these canvases in varied modulations, as in *Seascape*, in which an agitated sea and a broken sky seem to repeat the same notes of lucent blue. *Nocturnal Landscape* seizes the aura of twilight before real darkness shuts down, enveloping a village scene in a limpidity of low color. No lights flash in windows, no sunset glow is in the pellucid sky, only a definition of contours through a diaphanous veil. Something of the same effect is gained in *Trees*, in which a pale light appears between the closely set tree boles. Other excellent paintings include *Provincetown Harbor*, *Retreat* and *Porch Arabesque*. (Passedoit, March 18-April 6.)

ARTS / April 1957

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By STUART PRESTON

Visual investigations both bold and brave are carried on in Maurice Sievan's semi-abstract landscapes at the Passedoit Gallery. No matter if the color occasionally gets muddy or if the brushstrokes often seem at cross-purposes, the atmosphere of a scene is seriously felt out. Nor are emotional overtones overlooked either, as in the sinister weather attacking Nantucket or in the bright green fog that overhangs Long Island woods in June. Most striking of these obliquely descriptive canvases is "Siesta," where figures loil lazily in an over-heated room and where the brushwork itself, flurried and vague, perfectly conveys the feeling of a sleepy afternoon.